

ENGRAVE

1. Passage anchor

> “...and had my initials ****engraved**** on it, which made it feel personal straight away.”

Passage meaning

****engrave**** = cut letters, words, or a design into a hard surface so that they become permanent
****雕刻；刻上；銘刻****

Here, the speaker’s initials were physically cut into the fountain pen.

Practice

1. Her initials were ****engraved**** on the pen.
她的姓名首字母被****刻在****鋼筆上。
2. The ring was ****engraved**** with a short message.
戒指上****刻有****一則簡短訊息。

Core meanings of ENGRAVE

2. engrave — cut words/designs into a hard surface

= carve letters, words, symbols, or pictures into metal, stone, glass, wood, etc.
****雕刻；刻上****

Examples

1. His name was ****engraved**** on the trophy.
他的名字被****刻在****獎盃上。
2. The artist ****engraved a pattern**** into the metal.
藝術家把圖案****刻進金屬表面****。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. engrave something on/onto something

= cut words or designs onto a surface
****把.....刻在.....上****

Examples

1. They **engraved her name on the watch**.
他們把她的名字**刻在手錶上**。
2. A date was **engraved onto the plaque**.
日期被**刻在牌匾上**。

4. engrave something with something

= decorate or mark an object by cutting words/designs into it
在.....上刻有.....

Examples

1. The pen was **engraved with his initials**.
那支筆上**刻有他的姓名首字母**。
2. The box was **engraved with a floral design**.
盒子上**刻有花卉圖案**。

Very high-value pattern.

Decorative / artistic engraving

5. engrave — create a carved decorative design

= produce a design by cutting into a surface
雕花；刻圖案

Examples

1. The craftsman **engraved the silver plate** by hand.
工匠手工**雕刻銀盤**。
2. The bracelet was carefully **engraved** with leaves.
手鐲上仔細**雕刻了葉子圖案**。

Printing / traditional illustration

6. engrave — make a printing plate by cutting lines into a surface

= create an image or design on metal, wood, etc. for printing

製作雕版；雕刻印版

Examples

1. The image was **engraved on a metal plate**.

圖像被**雕刻在金屬印版上**。

2. The artist **engraved the illustration** for printing.

藝術家為印刷而**製作雕版插圖**。

More historical/artistic.

Figurative memory sense

7. be engraved on/in someone's memory

= be remembered very clearly and permanently

深深銘刻在記憶中；難以忘懷

Examples

1. That day is **engraved in my memory**.

那一天**深深銘刻在我的記憶中**。

2. Her words were **engraved on his mind**.

她的話**深深刻在他的腦海裡**。

This is the main figurative extension.

8. engrave something on someone's mind

= make an idea, image, or experience unforgettable

把……深深印在某人腦海中

Examples

1. The experience **engraved the lesson on his mind**.

那段經歷把這個教訓**深深刻在他的腦海中**。

2. The image was ****engraved on her memory****.

那個畫面****深深留在她的記憶裡****。

Related forms

9. engraving

A. act/process of engraving

****雕刻；鐫刻****

1. The ****engraving**** took several hours.

****雕刻工作****花了好幾個小時。

B. engraved image/design

****雕刻圖案；版畫****

2. The museum displayed several old ****engravings****.

博物館展出了幾幅古老****版畫****。

10. engraved

= marked or decorated by engraving

****雕刻的；刻有文字 / 圖案的****

Examples

1. She received an ****engraved watch****.

她收到一隻****刻字手錶****。

2. The ****engraved initials**** made the gift personal.

****刻上的姓名首字母****讓禮物更有個人意義。

11. engraver

= person or machine that engraves

****雕刻師；雕刻機****

Examples

1. The **engraver** added the name by hand.
雕刻師用手工刻上名字。
2. A laser **engraver** was used for the design.
圖案使用雷射**雕刻機**完成。

Modern manufacturing extensions

12. laser engraving

= engraving done with a laser

雷射雕刻

Examples

1. The company offers **laser engraving** on gifts.
公司提供禮品**雷射刻字**服務。
2. The initials were added by **laser engraving**.
姓名首字母是用**雷射雕刻**刻上的。

13. engraved jewelry / engraved gift

= jewelry or gift personalized with cut-in text or designs

刻字首飾；刻字禮物

Examples

1. She gave him an **engraved bracelet**.
她送了他一條**刻字手鐲**。
2. An **engraved gift** often feels more personal.
刻字禮物通常更有個人意義。

Key contrasts

14. engrave vs carve

****engrave****

= cut letters, lines, or designs into a hard surface, often shallow and precise

****刻字；雕刻****

****carve****

= cut material away to form a shape, figure, or deeper design

****雕刻；雕塑****

Compare:

> ****engrave**** a name on a ring

> 在戒指上刻名字

> ****carve**** a figure from wood

> 用木頭雕出人物

15. engrave vs inscribe

****inscribe****

= write, print, or carve words on something, often formally

****題寫；刻寫；銘刻****

****engrave****

= specifically emphasizes physically cutting into the surface

Compare:

> The medal was ****inscribed**** with a message.

> 獎牌上題寫 / 刻有訊息。

> The message was ****engraved**** into the metal.

> 訊息被實際刻進金屬表面。

16. engrave vs emboss

****engrave****

= cut into the surface

****凹刻****

****emboss****

= raise a design above the surface

****壓凸；浮雕壓印****

This is an important physical distinction.

17. engrave vs etch

****etch****

= create a design by cutting or chemically/laser marking a surface, often with fine lines

****蝕刻；刻蝕****

****engrave****

= broader traditional term for cutting a design physically into a surface

They overlap in modern manufacturing.

18. engrave vs print

****print****

= apply ink, toner, or another surface process

****印刷；印上****

****engrave****

= physically cut into the material

****刻進去****

So engraved text is normally more permanent and tactile than printed text.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****engrave**** is:

****make a permanent mark by cutting into a surface****

From this develop:

Personalization

engrave initials on a pen

→ ****把姓名首字母刻在鋼筆上****

Decoration

engrave a pattern

→ **雕刻圖案**

Traditional printing

engraved plate

→ **雕版 / 印版**

Memory metaphor

engraved in memory

→ **深深銘刻在記憶中**

Modern technology

laser engraving

→ **雷射雕刻**

The passage uses the personalization branch:

> **my initials engraved on it**

> → **上面刻了我的姓名首字母**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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engrave — cut words/designs into a surface	把文字、符號或圖案切刻進金屬、石頭、木材等表面；雕刻 / 刻上
engrave something on/onto something	把文字或圖案刻在某個物件表面
engrave something with something	在某物上刻上指定文字或圖案
engrave — decorative	在物件表面雕出裝飾圖案
engrave — printing/art	為印刷而在金屬、木材等表面製作雕版
be engraved in/on someone's memory	某事被非常清楚、長久地記住；深深銘刻在記憶中
engrave something on someone's mind	使某個印象、教訓等深深留在腦海
engraving — process	雕刻 / 鑄刻的過程
engraving — artwork	以雕版技法製作的圖像 / 版畫
engraved	表面已刻有文字或圖案的
engraver	進行雕刻的人或機器
laser engraving	使用雷射在物體表面刻字 / 刻圖的技術

Passage recap

> "...had my initials **engraved on it**..."

Here:

****engrave**** = ****to cut letters permanently into the surface of an object****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****刻上****

* ****雕刻****

* ****銘刻****

Natural contextual translation:

****上面還刻了我的姓名首字母。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****engrave****

= ****to cut words, letters, or a design into a hard surface so that the mark is permanent****

****雕刻；刻上****

The most important contrast is:

> ****engrave****

> → 把文字 / 圖案實際刻進表面

versus:

> ****print****

> → 把文字印在表面

and:

> ****emboss****

> → 把圖案壓成凸起

In the passage, engraving makes the pen feel more ****personal and permanent****, because the speaker's own initials are physically cut into the gift.